

February

5

1869

Striking gold

The world's biggest gold nugget was discovered in the Australian town of Moliagul. Two British miners struck gold when they unearthed the so-called "Welcome Stranger", which weighed an astonishing 72 kg (158 lb).



1661

Qing ruler

Emperor Kangxi of the Qing Dynasty began his reign in China. His rule lasted a record-breaking 61 years, making him the longest-reigning emperor in Chinese history.



Also on this day

1885 King Leopold II of Belgium set up the Congo Free State. He exploited the wild rubber growing on the land for his own personal gain.

1953 Children in Britain could finally eat as much chocolate as they wanted when sweet rationing ended eight years after the end of World War II.

1852

Museum of art

The State Hermitage Museum in Saint Petersburg, Russia, opened to the public. It contained a collection of paintings belonging to Empress Catherine the Great, and is now one of the world's most spectacular art museums.

Born this day

1985 Cristiano Ronaldo, Portuguese footballer. The winner of 31 major trophies, he has been awarded the *Ballon d'Or* for the world's best player five times, and has scored more than 700 goals.

